



ENTREPRENEURS FOR VIKSIT BHARAT

E-SUMMIT DCRUST '26

OFFICIAL RULEBOOK

Deenbandhu Chhotu Ram University of Science and Technology (DCRUST)
Murthal, Sonapat, Haryana

Event Dates: 28–29 September 2026
Venue: DCRUST Campus, Murthal, Sonapat

PART A — GENERAL RULES

The following provisions apply to every competition held under E-Summit DCRUST '26 unless a specific Part expressly states otherwise.

1. Participation

Participants must follow the participation and team-size requirements specified for their respective competition in Parts B through F of this rulebook.

2. Reporting

Participants and teams must be present and ready at the venue before their respective turn or scheduled participation begins.

A participant or team that is not present when their turn begins may be treated as absent and eliminated from that competition.

3. No-Show

If a registered participant or team fails to appear for their competition, they may be eliminated.

4. Fair Play and Conduct

Participants are expected to maintain, at all times during the event:

- Professional conduct
- Discipline
- Respect toward other participants, judges, and organizers
- Fair play

5. Disqualification

A participant or team may be eliminated or disqualified for any of the following:

- Cheating
- Deliberate manipulation of the competition
- Misconduct
- Disrupting the competition
- Violating event-specific rules
- Attempting to obtain an unfair advantage

6. Judging

Judges will evaluate participants according to the criteria specified for each competition in this rulebook.

Participants cannot demand changes to scores merely because they disagree with the judges' assessment. All scores awarded by the judging panel are final.

7. Organizer Authority

The organizers may take reasonable operational decisions necessary to ensure that each competition is conducted fairly, smoothly, and in accordance with its intended format.

8. Final Authority

The decision of the Organizers shall be final and binding. Participants are expected to respect all decisions and maintain the discipline and fairness of the event. Any violation may result in appropriate action.

PART B — CORPORATE STOCKS

Event Type	Individual
Format	Remote / Online

Corporate Stocks is a live online stock-market simulation competition conducted through an online stock-simulation application or platform. The competition uses simulated trading only and does not involve real-money investment.

1. Market

The simulated market will remain open until 3:00 PM. Participants may conduct trades until the market closes.

2. Trading

Participants may perform the trading actions permitted by the simulation platform. This may include:

- Buying
- Selling
- Short selling
- Other trading mechanisms available on the platform

Legitimate trading strategies are not unnecessarily restricted. Participants may trade repeatedly until the market closes.

3. Online Information

As the competition is conducted remotely, participants may use online information and resources available to them. No artificial restrictions are placed on internet usage.

4. Primary Winner Criterion

The participant with the highest final profit as recorded by the simulation platform at the official 3:00 PM market close will be ranked first. Profit is the primary and decisive ranking criterion. The number of trades executed or the number of companies held is not used as a primary ranking criterion.

5. Tie-Breaker

If two or more participants finish with exactly the same final profit, the participant who holds positions in the lower number of companies will rank higher. No additional tie-break criteria beyond this rule apply.

Example

Participant A — Final Profit: ₹2,00,000; Companies invested in: 5

Participant B — Final Profit: ₹2,00,000; Companies invested in: 4

Result: Participant B wins the tie-break, having invested in fewer companies.

6. Platform

The exact stock-simulation application or platform to be used will be communicated separately by the organizers ahead of the event.

PART C — ADVERTISING COMPETITION

Team Size	1 – 4 participants
Format	Completely Offline

1. Core Concept

Each team will receive an assigned idea, product, service, or concept through a chit or brief provided by the organizers. Different teams may receive different assigned concepts.

Teams must develop an advertisement around their assigned concept and attempt to sell it to the judges. This is not merely a graphic-design competition — teams are expected to demonstrate market understanding, advertising strategy, creativity, execution, and persuasive selling ability. Evaluation focuses on how effectively the team responds to and markets its assigned concept rather than the inherent popularity or commercial value of the concept itself.

The central challenge

UNDERSTAND → CREATE → ADVERTISE → SELL

2. Assignment

The product, idea, service, or concept assigned to each team is decided and provided by the organizers. Assigned concepts may differ between teams.

3. Objective

Teams must create an advertising approach that effectively communicates the value of their assigned concept and convinces the judges to purchase, adopt, or support it.

4. Preparation

Preparation time will be provided as determined by the organizers.

5. Resources

Teams will work under the conditions and resources specified by the organizers at the competition venue.

6. Selling

The advertisement must ultimately function as a sales effort. Teams should demonstrate:

- Understanding of the target audience
- Customer needs
- Market positioning
- Persuasive advertising
- Effective presentation
- Ability to sell the assigned concept

7. Evaluation

Criterion	Weight	What Is Evaluated
Market Understanding	30%	• Understanding of the target market • Customer needs • Understanding of the assigned product, service, or idea • Market positioning • Relevance of the advertising approach
Execution	25%	• How effectively the team converts its advertising concept into an actual presentation or performance • Delivery, performance, and implementation • Coordination and effectiveness of execution
Overall Pitch	30%	• The team's ability to sell and persuade • Persuasiveness, clarity, confidence, and structure • Ability to convince the judges • Overall effectiveness of the sales pitch
Creativity	15%	• Originality and creative thinking • Novelty of the concept • Creative presentation • Memorability of the advertisement
TOTAL	100%	

Important distinction

Execution evaluates how effectively the advertising concept is created and delivered.

Overall Pitch evaluates how convincingly the team sells the concept to the judges.

These two categories are judged independently and are not treated as identical.

PART D — STARTUP SUPPLY

Event Type	Two-person negotiation competition
Composition per Round	1 Startup + 1 Supplier

Startup Supply is primarily a negotiation competition. Negotiation is its core mechanic, and every rule in this Part exists to support and, where necessary, resolve that negotiation.

1. Core Objective

The objective is for the Startup and the Supplier to negotiate and reach a common final deal or price acceptable to both sides. Participants are expected to use negotiation, persuasion, communication, strategy, counteroffers, and decision-making. The central goal is reaching a mutually agreed price.

2. Price Chits

Each participant receives a chit containing their relevant monetary value or price constraint. Participants privately record the monetary limit stated on their chit. There are no secret business objectives — the monetary values written on the chits are the only private information in the round.

3. Negotiation

Participants negotiate privately. They may:

- Discuss the deal
- Make offers
- Make counteroffers
- Persuade the other participant
- Strategically disclose or withhold information about their chit
- Use negotiation strategy

Participants are not required to immediately reveal their chit value.

4. Private Discussion Period

If the participants are not making progress or are unable to reach a decision, they may be given a private discussion period of up to 2 minutes. During this period:

- The two participants may move to the designated private discussion area.
- They may discuss their respective values and may reveal their chit values if they choose.
- They may negotiate freely, using persuasion and strategy, within the framework of the competition.

5. Reaching a Deal

The primary objective is to reach one common final price agreed upon by both participants. Both participants must agree to the final deal — a deal is considered successful only when both sides accept the agreed price.

6. Multiple Offers

Participants may make multiple offers and counteroffers. Negotiation may continue until both participants agree on a common price, or until the negotiation is unsuccessful.

7. Failure to Reach Agreement

If the participants fail to reach a common decision after the negotiation process, both participants are eliminated from that round. There is no winner when no mutually acceptable agreement is reached.

8. Closed-Bid Mechanism

Before negotiation starts, each participant privately records the limit from their chit. If the final agreed price lies exactly halfway between both recorded positions, the tie is awarded to the participant who first proposed that exact final price during the negotiation.

Example — Exact Tie

Supplier's position: ₹30,000 Startup's position: ₹20,000

Final agreed price: ₹25,000

₹25,000 is exactly ₹5,000 away from the Supplier's position and ₹5,000 away from the Startup's position — an exact tie.

If the Startup first proposed ₹25,000 during the negotiation, the Startup wins.

If the Supplier first proposed ₹25,000 during the negotiation, the Supplier wins.

The deciding factor is strictly who first proposed the exact final agreed price.

10. Final Proposal Record

Where a tie-break is required, the organizers or judges may verify the sequence of offers made during the negotiation to determine which participant first proposed the final agreed price. Participants must make their offers clearly enough for the organizers or judges to determine this sequence.

11. Important Game Principle

Startup Supply is not intended to be simply a “highest price versus lowest price” competition. Negotiation is the central skill being tested, and participants must attempt in good faith to reach a mutually acceptable common deal.

12. Illustrative Example**Example — Range of Outcomes**

Supplier's stated position: ₹30,000 Startup's stated position: ₹20,000

Possible final deal of ₹27,000 — closer to the Supplier's position.

Possible final deal of ₹23,000 — closer to the Startup's position.

Possible final deal of ₹25,000 — exactly halfway between both positions, triggering the tie-break rule in Section 9.

13. Elimination

If no mutually acceptable final price is reached, both participants are eliminated.

PART E — PITCHING COMPETITION

Round 1	Online video submission
Final Round	Physical / offline pitching round at DCRUST
Final Round Size	Approximately 20–25 teams

1. Round 1 — Online Submission

Participants submit a pitch video through the Google Drive submission mechanism specified by the organizers. The Round 1 pitch duration is 5 minutes. The video must clearly present the startup or business idea.

2. Final Round

Selected teams proceed to the physical final round at DCRUST. The final round is a live startup pitching competition.

3. Ideas / Startups

Participants may present startup or business ideas of their choice. Both existing startups and new ideas may participate.

4. Prototype

A prototype is not mandatory. Participants may present their business or startup idea without a physical prototype.

5. Use of AI

Participants may use AI as part of their preparation and development process. However, participants remain responsible for the originality of their final work, the accuracy of their information, their understanding of their business, and the quality of their final presentation.

6. Evaluation

Criterion	Weight	What Is Evaluated
Problem Clarity & Proposed Solution	10%	- Clarity and importance of the problem being addressed - Clarity and effectiveness of the proposed solution
Market Potential	20%	- Target market and market opportunity - Customer demand and growth potential - Commercial potential
Business Model	15%	- Revenue model and value creation - Commercial logic - Sustainability of the model
Feasibility & Scalability	25%	- Practical and technical/operational feasibility - Resource requirements and execution potential - Scalability and expansion potential
Q&A	10%	- Understanding of the business - Ability to answer questions and defend the proposal - Logical thinking and confidence

Criterion	Weight	What Is Evaluated
Originality	15%	• Novelty and differentiation • Original thinking and distinctiveness
Social Cause Bonus	5%	• Additional marks for a proposal that meaningfully contributes to a social or environmental cause (e.g. environmental improvement, sustainability, social welfare, community benefit) • The social impact must be genuine and meaningful rather than a superficial claim
TOTAL	100%	

PART F — TURN THE COAT

Event Type

Individual

Participants must demonstrate the ability to argue both sides of an assigned topic. The defining challenge of Turn the Court is a participant's ability to personally switch their position and reasoning during the competition.

1. Topic

The topic will be provided at the venue. Participants will not receive the competition topic beforehand.

2. Both Sides

Each participant must argue one side of the topic and then the opposing side of the same topic. Participants must be capable of adapting their reasoning when their position changes.

3. Switch Mechanism

A buzzer will be used during the competition. When the judges press the buzzer, the participant must switch to the opposing position, immediately adapting their argument and continuing to present from the opposite perspective.

4. Switching Control

The judges control when a participant must switch, and also determine the timing and frequency of switches during the round.

5. Preparation

The topic is provided at the venue. Participants cannot use notes or external resources during their performance.

6. Evaluation

Criterion	Weight	What Is Evaluated
Personal / Position Switching	50%	- Ability to switch between opposing positions and adapt reasoning - Ability to continue effectively after the buzzer - Ability to argue both sides and demonstrate flexibility of thought - Performance under changing instructions
Creativity	25%	- Originality of arguments - Creative reasoning and different perspectives - Ability to generate interesting arguments
Effective Communication	25%	- Clarity, confidence, and articulation - Persuasiveness and delivery - Overall communication quality
TOTAL	100%	

7. Failure to Switch

If a participant refuses or fails to switch to the opposing position when instructed by the judges, they may be removed from the competition.

8. Running Out of Arguments

If a participant runs out of meaningful arguments or stops prematurely, marks may be deducted based on performance.

PART G — FINAL PROVISIONS

The organizers reserve the authority to:

- Ensure fair and orderly conduct of all competitions
- Interpret competition rules where an operational situation arises
- Take appropriate action against violations
- Eliminate or disqualify participants who violate the rules
- Make reasonable decisions necessary for the smooth functioning of the event

The decision of the Organizers shall be final and binding. Participants are expected to respect all decisions and maintain the discipline and fairness of the event. Any violation may result in appropriate action.
